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FRIENDS FROM NORTH, FOES FROM SOUTH

INDIA, UNITED FRONT, AND THE HIJACKING OF FLIGHT IC-814

'India played a very important role in getting Dostum and Massoud together [in the 1990s]. Massoud was very unhappy with Dostum. We [India] got the Shias and Dostum and Massoud together and gave money. We were looking for all anti-Taliban groups and trying to get them to work together.'

X, R&AW official who worked closely with the United Front in the 1990s[1]

'If we see the negative dimension of the [IC-814] hijack, we also need to see the positive dimension ... all the people were rescued ... it was great and positive work that the Taliban did ... [also] the Taliban has an independent viewpoint, regardless of what Pakistan says'.

Syed Akbar Agha, close to the Taliban in 1990s and former chief of the Jaish-ul-Muslimeen, 2013[2]

Friends from north

The emergence of the anti-Taliban *Jabha-yi Muttahid-i Islāmi-yi Millī barā-yi Nijāt-i Afghānistān* (United Islamic Front for the Salvation of Afghanistan) umbrella, mostly known as the Northern Alliance, or just the United Front (UF) in 1996, was a necessary condition for the rise of partisans in India. Support from